Christopher White

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Analytical and solution-focused leader with experience building and leading high-performing teams delivering high impact solutions focused on exceeding customer needs and expectations. Expertise working in environments from early-stage startups to Fortune 500 companies. Adept at accessing ambiguous ecosystems and working closely with stakeholders to build solutions that balance market dynamics, technology, scalability, and time-to-market requirements. Collaborative team builder who relentlessly focuses on creating a healthy environment where each team member is empowered to demonstrate ownership, bias for action in a collaborative agile culture focusing on team cohesion, quality, innovation, and efficiency.

Areas of Expertise

AWS, Cloud Services/SAAS/Full Stack Development, Microservices, Serverless Architecture, JSON RestAPIs, GraphQL, Webhooks, Java, JavaScript/TypeScript, Node.js, Python, Android, iOS, React.js, ReactNative, SQL/NoSQL Databases, Agile Methodology, CI/CD

Accomplishments

- ✓ At Rivian, delivered a Customer Service portal providing a 360-degree view of customer data and interaction with internal customer service. Worked closely with product, UX, business and our internal customers to improve customer issues resolution time. Calibrated and executed agile development processes to increase productivity, team velocity, predictability and reduce ambiguity. Defined the on-call process for handling incoming issues, allocating team resources, and adhering to customer-issue SLAs.
- ✓ Delivered an Amazon Music mobile in-app merchandise feature to 38M+ US customers in March 2021, allowing artists to curate and sell special merchandise to customers in the Amazon Music mobile and web applications. This feature required collaboration with many engineering teams, product, UX, marketing and business teams to ensure we could successfully execute our project plan and deliver on time.
- ✓ At Western Digital, championed and delivered a new iOS and Android client using Reach Native for mobile and React.js for the web client. I also introduced serverless components such as AWS Lambda functions to reduce the need of building microservices for simply query APIs. This was part of a full re-architecture of NAS hardware, cloud ecosystem and NAS clients.
- ✓ At Lab126, hired a new team and lead the development of a next-generation e-Ink Kindle content renderer to support complex formatting features required by large publishers whose formatting is their branding.

Professional Experience

Software Architect

Page Mill Consulting | Los Angeles, CA **Sept 2023 – Present**

- Designed and developed a benchmarking tool to compare **GraphQL vs REST API performance** under varying loads, producing data that informed API architecture decisions for two client platforms.
- Built a full-stack **AWS AppSync application** to evaluate ease of development, operational resilience, and production readiness, cutting projected onboarding time for new developers by ~25%.

Senior Development Manager

Rivian | Los Angeles, CA **Oct 2021 – April 2023**

- Managed two engineering teams; One focused on a customer service portal (CRM) and the other on a facilities project management used as the single source of truth for all of Rivian's facilities remodeling and new construction projects.
- The Customer Services team of 10 engineers responsible for developing an in-house full stack customer resource management (CRM) solution in AWS, providing a 360-degree view of customer data including status, interactions, work orders, and customer audit logs. The solution aggregates multiple data sources via Rest API and GraphQL to present a single source of truth for customer data used by the internal customer service gents.
- The Facilities team consisted of 9 remote employees and 6 remote contractors responsible for delivering a solution that tracks all stages of facilities projects (new construction/remodeling) from inception, budgeting, tracking to completion.
- Calibrated and executed agile development processes to increase productivity, team velocity, predictability and reduce ambiguity. Solidified alignment and collaboration with product, UX, business and internal customers to ensure stakeholder's expectations were met. Defined the on-call process for handling and triaging incoming issues, allocating team resources, and adhering to customer-issue SLAs.

Software Development Manager

Amazon | Santa Monica, CA **Oct 2017 - May 2021**

- **Amazon Music**
- Hired and managed a remote 10-person team responsible for delivering Amazon Music features focusing on enhancing artist-to-fan engagement. This feature shipped in March 2011 to 38M+ customers on the Amazon Music iOS and Android.
- The merchandise required collaborating internal marketing and business teams along with other engineering teams, getting technical support commitments all aligned with the feature project plan.
- Integrated with the retails Amazon.com APIs to allow merchandise to be viewed from the Amazon Music clients.
- Delivered backend service integration with Twitch APIs to receive notifications of artists live events allowing customers to view Twitch live content from the Amazon Music mobile applications.
- **Amazon Studios**
- Led an engineering team working on an Amazon Studios content management solution responsible for integrations with external and internal services to provide a source of truth for all Amazon Studios content creation process. API and SQS integrations included RightsLine (an external content rights management tool), internal budgeting service and asset management service.
- Managed support engineers for operations, DevOps, and customer service. In DevOps, we migrated to using CI/CD and Infrastructure as a service (IaaS) for provisioning all AWS services for both product and testing.
- **Prime Video**
- Led a 10-person engineering team responsible for maintaining a legacy Content Rights Management solution while architecting a new solution. The solution, an integral part of the publishing pipeline, manages and maintains all Prime Video licensed content rights including available dates, region restrictions and pricing.
- Continually made improvements to the legacy solution to improve operator's experience and reduce time spent on managing Amazon Prime's content rights.
- Implemented and delivered a new scalable Content Rights Management solution that adhered to a content rights industry standards format and provided validation and troubleshooting support for the operator, improving operator throughput by 40%.

Senior Engineering Manager

Western Digital | Mountain View, CA **May 2015 - June 2017**

- To reduce dependencies on native mobile developers, I prototyped a hybrid mobile client to display photos and files stored in the Western Digital customers NAS devices. After discussion with multiple teams and steak holders, we decided to move forward with using React Native to build both the iOS and Android clients and React.js for the web client. This reduced our development timelines thus ensuring an on-time delivery.
- Built a team of 10 engineers spread over two locations. I was responsible for delivering the NAS device Rest API, ReactNative and React.js mobile clients shipped in early 2017 to millions of customers.
- Designed and implemented a push notification service used by the ecosystem to send iOS and Android push notifications for new media and media sharing alerts.

Head of Engineering

Reach150 Social | Palo Alto, CA **Dec 2012 - April 2015**

- Led a three-person startup that created a referral management system realtors could use to grow business and sphere of influence.
- Developed, maintained, and provided all customer support for the referral software as a service (SaaS) solution hosted by AWS. Integrated with Google AdWords Rest API to allow customers to enable and manage advertising directly through the web applications. The auto generated ads were fully automated leveraging customer profile information.

Software Development Manager

Amazon | Cupertino, CA **Nov 2009 - Dec 2012**

- Hired a team of 12 engineers and delivered new Kindle content renderer to add support for e-pub/HTM formatting.
- Collaborated with Amazon teams in Paris, India, and Seattle to design, architect, and implement services. This included integrating with existing Kindle services and operational tooling to ingest, format, and deliver content to the renderer
- Championed and managed a web-based Kindle client that supports the same formatting capabilities as the new e-Ink renderer.

Education

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | California Polytechnic State University | San Luis Obispo, CA